

Discipline and Complaints Policy

Vertex Volleyball Club is committed to creating a safe, respectful, and positive environment for all athletes, coaches, parents, administrators, officials, and spectators.

This policy exists to:

- promote respectful conduct
- provide fair and consistent procedures
- address concerns appropriately
- protect the well-being of all participants
- maintain a healthy club culture

All members of the club are expected to follow the standards outlined in the Club Handbook, OVA policies, Safe Sport policies, and all applicable codes of conduct.

General Principles

All complaints and disciplinary matters will be handled:

- fairly
- respectfully
- confidentially when possible
- in a timely manner
- without retaliation

The club encourages individuals to resolve concerns respectfully and directly whenever appropriate before escalating matters formally.

Types of Complaints

Complaints may include, but are not limited to:

- disrespectful conduct
- bullying or harassment
- unsafe behavior

- discrimination
 - inappropriate communication
 - social media misconduct
 - violations of club policies
 - spectator misconduct
 - coach conduct concerns
 - athlete conduct concerns
 - parent conduct concerns
 - failure to follow Safe Sport policies
 - repeated team rule violations
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Informal Resolution

Whenever appropriate, concerns should first be addressed through respectful communication between the individuals involved.

Examples may include:

- athlete/coaching communication
- team expectations
- misunderstandings
- minor conduct concerns

The club encourages solution-focused communication whenever possible.

Formal Complaint Process

If a concern cannot be resolved informally, a formal complaint may be submitted to club leadership.

Formal complaints should include:

- name(s) of individuals involved
- description of the incident
- relevant dates or locations
- supporting information if available

Complaints should be submitted as soon as reasonably possible after the incident occurs.

Review Process

Once a complaint is received:

1. Club leadership will review the complaint
2. Additional information may be requested
3. Relevant individuals may be contacted
4. Appropriate actions or decisions will be determined

The club reserves the right to involve:

- Safe Sport representatives
 - Ontario Volleyball Association (OVA)
 - external authorities
 - law enforcement
when necessary.
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Possible Disciplinary Actions

Depending on the severity or frequency of behavior, disciplinary action may include:

- verbal warning
- written warning
- temporary suspension
- removal from practices or competitions
- restricted participation
- parent or athlete meetings
- probationary status
- removal from the team or club

Serious misconduct may result in immediate suspension or removal.

Safe Sport & Serious Misconduct

Complaints involving:

- abuse

- harassment
- discrimination
- bullying
- hazing
- inappropriate adult-athlete conduct
- threats or violence
- violations of Safe Sport policies

may be immediately escalated to the appropriate authorities or governing organizations.

Athlete safety and well-being will always remain the highest priority.

Playing Time & Coaching Decisions

Playing time decisions, team strategy, lineups, and coaching decisions are generally not considered disciplinary matters.

Families are encouraged to follow the club communication procedures and 24-hour rule when discussing these concerns.

Coaches maintain final discretion regarding:

- lineups
 - substitutions
 - practice structure
 - team systems
 - competition decisions
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Retaliation

Retaliation against any individual who submits a complaint or participates in an investigation will not be tolerated.

Any retaliation may result in disciplinary action.

Confidentiality

The club will make reasonable efforts to maintain confidentiality throughout the complaint process.

However, complete confidentiality cannot always be guaranteed depending on the nature of the situation.

Final Authority

Vertex Volleyball Club reserves the right to make final decisions regarding all disciplinary matters in accordance with:

- club policies
- Safe Sport requirements
- OVA policies
- applicable laws and regulations

The primary goal of all disciplinary procedures is to:

- maintain a safe environment
 - support athlete well-being
 - encourage accountability
 - preserve a positive club culture
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